



INTRODUCTION

- One of the highest civilian honours of India
- Given in three categories: Padma Vibhushan (for exceptional and distinguished service), Padma Bhushan (distinguished service of higher order) and Padma Shri (distinguished service).
- The award seeks to recognize achievements in all fields of activities or disciplines where an element of public service is involved.
- The Awards are given in various disciplines/ fields of activities, viz.- art, social work, public affairs, science and engineering, trade and industry, medicine, literature and education, sports, civil service, etc.

FACTS

- Padma Awards were instituted in the year 1954
- The awards are announced annually on the eve of Republic Day
- Conferred by the President of India at ceremonial functions held at Rashtrapati Bhawan usually around March/ April
- 3 times Interruption(s) during the years 1978 and 1979 and 1993 to 1997.

PADMA AWARDS 2026

- Announced on the eve of 77th Republic Day
- President approved 131 Padma Awards, including 2 duo cases (in a duo case, the Award is counted as one)
- The list comprises — 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri Awards.
- Among the awardees, 19 are women, 6 persons from the category of Foreigners / NRI / PIO / OCI and 16 Posthumous awardees
- The highest number of winners this year were from Maharashtra (15), followed by Tamil Nadu (13), Uttar Pradesh (11), West Bengal (11), and Kerala (8).
- Out of 113 Padma Shri - 45 people have been chosen under the 'Unsung heroes' category - It refers to grassroots level achievers - also referred to as 'Peoples' Padma'.

Padma Vibhushan (5)

Padma Vibhushan 2026 Winners (5):

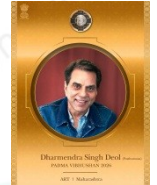
SN	Name	Field	State / Country
1	Shri Dharmendra Singh Deol (Posthumous)	Art	Maharashtra
2	Shri K T Thomas	Public Affairs	Kerala



3	Ms. N Rajam	Art	Uttar Pradesh
4	Shri P Narayanan	Literature and Education	Kerala
5	Shri V S Achuthanandhan (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Kerala

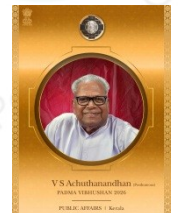
Dharmendra Singh Deol (Posthumous) – Art

- 8 December 1935 – 24 November 2025
- popularly known as the "He-Man" of Bollywood
- debuted in Dil Bhi Tera Hum Bhi Tere (1960)
- He served as a Member of Parliament (Lok Sabha) for the BJP from Bikaner, Rajasthan (2004–2009)
- Padma Bhushan (2012)
- Filmfare Lifetime Achievement Award (1997)
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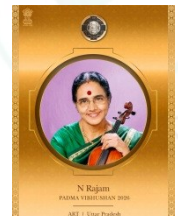
Shri V S Achuthanandhan (Posthumous) – Public Affairs

- 20 October 1923 – 21 July 2025
- popularly known as VS, he was a towering figure in Indian politics and a founding member of the Communist Party of India (Marxist).
- He served as the 20th Chief Minister of Kerala (2006–2011) and was a relentless advocate for social justice, workers' rights, and environmental protection
- Often referred to as the "Fidel Castro of Kerala"



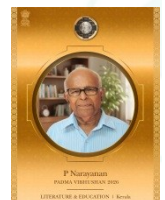
Ms. N Rajam - Art

- Dr.N. Rajamis alegendary Indian violinist renowned for her pioneering contributions toHindustani classical music.
- She is best known for developing the"Gayaki Ang"(vocal style) on the violin, which allows the instrument to mimic the nuances and emotional depth of the human voice
- specialized in the Gwalior gharana of Hindustani music
- Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship(2012)
- Padma Bhushan(2004)
- Sangeet Natak Akademi Award(1990)
- Padma Shri(1984)



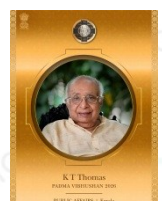
Shri P Narayanan – Literature & Education

- Indian journalist, author, and veteran leader of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)
- He is a co-founder and former Editor-in-Chief of the Malayalam dailyJanmabhumi.



Shri K T Thomas - Public Affairs

- Former Supreme Court judge He presided over the bench that confirmed the death sentences in theRajiv Gandhi assassinationcase.His memoir- "Honeybees of Solomon"(2008)
- Padma Bhushanin 2007



Padma Bhushan (13)

Padma Bhushan 2026 winners (13):



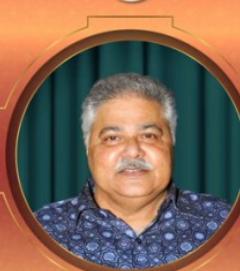
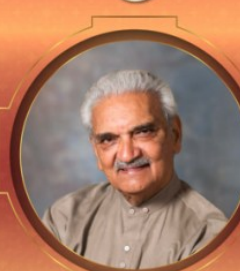
SN	Name	Field	State / Country
1	Ms. Alka Yagnik	Art	Maharashtra
2	Shri Bhagat Singh Koshyari	Public Affairs	Uttarakhand
3	Shri Kallipatti Ramasamy Palaniswamy	Medicine	Tamil Nadu
4	Shri Mammootty	Art	Kerala
5	Dr. Nori Dattatreyaudu	Medicine	United States of America
6	Shri Piyush Pandey (Posthumous)	Art	Maharashtra
7	Shri S K M Maeilanandhan	Social Work	Tamil Nadu
8	Shri Shatavadhani R Ganesh	Art	Karnataka
9	Shri Shibu Soren (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Jharkhand
10	Shri Uday Kotak	Trade and Industry	Maharashtra
11	Shri V K Malhotra (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Delhi
12	Shri Vellappally Natesan	Public Affairs	Kerala
13	Shri Vijay Amritraj	Sports	United States of America

Padma Bhushan Awardees (13)

Alka Yagnik PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 ART Maharashtra Playback Singer	Bhagat Singh Koshyari PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 PUBLIC AFFAIRS Uttarakhand Veteran Indian politician and senior member of RSS. 22nd Governor of Maharashtra (2019–2023); 2nd CM of Uttarakhand (2001–2002)	Kallipatti Ramasamy Palaniswamy PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 MEDICINE Tamil Nadu Indian gastroenterologist and medical educator	Vijay Amritraj PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 SPORTS USA legendary Indian former professional tennis player and sports commentator; 2024 International Tennis Hall of Fame inductee
Piyush Pandey (Posthumous) PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 ART Maharashtra Father of modern Indian advertising; Padma Shri in 2016.	Mammootty PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 ART Kerala legendary Indian actor - monumental work in Malayalam cinema; Padma Shri in 1998	Nori Dattatreyaudu PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 MEDICINE USA Indian-American radiating oncologist; Padma Shri (2015) and Padma Bhushan (2026)	Shibu Soren (Posthumous) PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 PUBLIC AFFAIRS Jharkhand Key architect of Jharkhand state; 3-time CM of Jharkhand; served as Union Minister for Coal
S K M Maeilanandhan PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 SOCIAL WORK Tamil Nadu Renowned Indian Industrialist; President of World Community Service Centre; Padma Shri in 2013	Shatavadhani R Ganesh PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 ART Karnataka practitioner of the art of avadhana; author in Sanskrit and Kannada and an extempore poet in multiple languages	Vellappally Natesan PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 PUBLIC AFFAIRS Kerala influential social leader; founded the political party Bharath Dharma Jana Sena (BDJS)	
Uday Kotak PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 TRADE & INDUSTRY Maharashtra founder of Kotak Mahindra Bank	V K Malhotra (Posthumous) PADMA BHUSHAN 2026 PUBLIC AFFAIRS Delhi veteran BJP leader		

Padma Shri(113)



 Madhavan Ranganathan PADMA SHRI 2026 ART Maharashtra Indian actor, director, and producer	 Satish Shah (Posthumous) PADMA SHRI 2026 ART Maharashtra legendary Indian actor and comedian	 Anil Kumar Rastogi PADMA SHRI 2026 ART Uttar Pradesh veteran Lucknow-based theatre, film, and television actor
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 Savita Punia PADMA SHRI 2026 SPORTS Haryana legendary Indian field hockey goalkeeper and former captain	 Praveen Kumar PADMA SHRI 2026 SPORTS Uttar Pradesh Indian para high jumper	 K Pajanivel PADMA SHRI 2026 SPORTS Puducherry Renowned Silambam expert - traditional Tamil martial art
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 Vladimer Mestvirishvili (Posthumous) PADMA SHRI 2026 SPORTS Georgia legendary Georgian wrestling coach; first foreign coach to receive this honor; transformed Indian wrestling over two decades (2003–2017)	 Lars Christian Koch PADMA SHRI 2026 ART Germany renowned musicologist - made significant contributions to the research and preservation of Indian music	 Liudmila Viktorovna Khokhlova PADMA SHRI 2026 LITERATURE & EDUCATION Russia Russian Indologist and professor
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Padma Shri 2026 winners (113):

SN	Name	Field	State / Country
1	Shri A E Muthunayagam	Science and Engineering	Kerala
2	Shri Anil Kumar Rastogi	Art	Uttar Pradesh
3	Shri Anke Gowda M.	Social Work	Karnataka
4	Ms. Armida Fernandez	Medicine	Maharashtra
5	Shri Arvind Vaidya	Art	Gujarat
6	Shri Ashok Khade	Trade and Industry	Maharashtra
7	Shri Ashok Kumar Singh	Science and Engineering	Uttar Pradesh
8	Shri Asok Kumar Halder	Literature and Education	West Bengal
9	Shri Baldev Singh	Sports	Punjab
10	Shri Bhagwandas Raikwar	Sports	Madhya Pradesh
11	Shri Bharat Singh Bharti	Art	Bihar
12	Shri Bhiklya Ladakya Dhinda	Art	Maharashtra
13	Shri Bishwa Bandhu (Posthumous)	Art	Bihar
14	Shri Brij Lal Bhat	Social Work	Jammu and Kashmir
15	Shri Buddha Rashmi Mani	Others – Archaeology	Uttar Pradesh
16	Dr. Budhri Tati	Social Work	Chhattisgarh
17	Shri Chandramouli Gaddamanugu	Science and Engineering	Telangana
18	Shri Charan Hembram	Literature and Education	Odisha
19	Shri Chiranjilal Yadav	Art	Uttar Pradesh
20	Ms. Deepika Reddy	Art	Telangana
21	Shri Dharmiklal Chunilal Pandya	Art	Gujarat
22	Shri Gadde Babu Rajendra Prasad	Art	Andhra Pradesh
23	Shri Gafruddin Mewati Jogi	Art	Rajasthan
24	Shri Gambir Singh Yonzon	Literature and Education	West Bengal
25	Shri Garimella Balakrishna Prasad (Posthumous)	Art	Andhra Pradesh
26	Ms. Gayatri Balasubramanian & Ms. Ranjani Balasubramanian (Duo)	Art	Tamil Nadu
27	Shri Gopal Ji Trivedi	Science and Engineering	Bihar
28	Shri Guduru Venkat Rao	Medicine	Telangana
29	Shri H V Hande	Medicine	Tamil Nadu
30	Shri Hally War	Social Work	Meghalaya
31	Shri Hari Madhab Mukhopadhyay (Posthumous)	Art	West Bengal
32	Shri Haricharan Saikia	Art	Assam
33	Ms. Harmanpreet Kaur Bhullar	Sports	Punjab

34	Shri Inderjit Singh Sidhu	Social Work	Chandigarh
35	Shri Janardan Bapurao Bothe	Social Work	Maharashtra
36	Shri Jogesh Deuri	Others – Agriculture	Assam
37	Shri Juzer Vasi	Science and Engineering	Maharashtra
38	Shri Jyotish Debnath	Art	West Bengal
39	Shri K Pajanivel	Sports	Puducherry
40	Shri K Ramasamy	Science and Engineering	Tamil Nadu
41	Shri K Vijay Kumar	Civil Service	Tamil Nadu
42	Shri Kabindra Purkayastha (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Assam
43	Shri Kailash Chandra Pant	Literature and Education	Madhya Pradesh
44	Ms. Kalamandalam Vimala Menon	Art	Kerala
45	Shri Kewal Krishan Thakral	Medicine	Uttar Pradesh
46	Shri Khem Raj Sundriyal	Art	Haryana
47	Ms. Kollakal Devaki Amma G	Social Work	Kerala
48	Shri Krishnamurty Balasubramanian	Science and Engineering	Telangana
49	Shri Kumar Bose	Art	West Bengal
50	Shri Kumarasamy Thangaraj	Science and Engineering	Telangana
51	Prof. (Dr.) Lars-Christian Koch	Art	Germany
52	Ms. Liudmila Viktorovna Khokhlova	Literature and Education	Russia
53	Shri Madhavan Ranganathan	Art	Maharashtra
54	Shri Maganti Murali Mohan	Art	Andhra Pradesh
55	Shri Mahendra Kumar Mishra	Literature and Education	Odisha
56	Shri Mahendra Nath Roy	Literature and Education	West Bengal
57	Shri Mamidala Jagadesh Kumar	Literature and Education	Delhi
58	Ms. Mangala Kapoor	Literature and Education	Uttar Pradesh
59	Shri Mir Hajibhai Kasambhai	Art	Gujarat
60	Shri Mohan Nagar	Social Work	Madhya Pradesh
61	Shri Narayan Vyas	Others – Archaeology	Madhya Pradesh
62	Shri Naresh Chandra Dev Varma	Literature and Education	Tripura
63	Shri Nilesh Vinodchandra Mandlewala	Social Work	Gujarat
64	Shri Nuruddin Ahmed	Art	Assam
65	Shri Othuvar Thiruthani Swaminathan	Art	Tamil Nadu
66	Dr. Padma Gurmet	Medicine	Ladakh
67	Shri Palkonda Vijay Anand Reddy	Medicine	Telangana
68	Ms. Pokhila Lekthepe	Art	Assam
69	Dr. Prabhakar Basavprabhu Kore	Literature and Education	Karnataka

70	Shri Prateek Sharma	Medicine	United States of America
71	Shri Praveen Kumar	Sports	Uttar Pradesh
72	Shri Prem Lal Gautam	Science and Engineering	Himachal Pradesh
73	Shri Prosenjit Chatterjee	Art	West Bengal
74	Dr. Punniamurthy Natesan	Medicine	Tamil Nadu
75	Shri R Krishnan (Posthumous)	Art	Tamil Nadu
76	Shri R V S Mani	Civil Service	Delhi
77	Shri Rabilal Tudu	Literature and Education	West Bengal
78	Shri Raghupat Singh (Posthumous)	Others – Agriculture	Uttar Pradesh
79	Shri Raghuvir Tukaram Khedkar	Art	Maharashtra
80	Shri Rajastapathi Kaliappa Goundar	Art	Tamil Nadu
81	Shri Rajendra Prasad	Medicine	Uttar Pradesh
82	Shri Rama Reddy Mamidi (Posthumous)	Others – Animal Husbandry	Telangana
83	Shri Ramamurthy Sreedher	Others – Radio Broadcasting	Delhi
84	Shri Ramchandra Godbole & Ms. Suneeta Godbole (Duo)	Medicine	Chhattisgarh
85	Shri Ratilal Borisagar	Literature and Education	Gujarat
86	Shri Rohit Sharma	Sports	Maharashtra
87	Ms. S G Susheelamma	Social Work	Karnataka
88	Shri Sangyusang S Pongener	Art	Nagaland
89	Sant Niranjana Dass	Others – Spiritualism	Punjab
90	Shri Sarat Kumar Patra	Art	Odisha
91	Shri Saroj Mandal	Medicine	West Bengal
92	Shri Satish Shah (Posthumous)	Art	Maharashtra
93	Shri Satyanarayan Nuwal	Trade and Industry	Maharashtra
94	Ms. Savita Punia	Sports	Haryana
95	Prof. Shafi Shauq	Literature and Education	Jammu and Kashmir
96	Shri Shashi Shekhar Vempati	Literature and Education	Karnataka
97	Shri Shrirang Devaba Lad	Others – Agriculture	Maharashtra
98	Ms. Shubha Venkatesha Iyengar	Science and Engineering	Karnataka
99	Shri Shyam Sundar	Medicine	Uttar Pradesh
100	Shri Simanchal Patro	Art	Odisha
101	Ms. Sivasankari	Literature and Education	Tamil Nadu
102	Dr. Suresh Hanagavadi	Medicine	Karnataka
103	Swami Brahmdev Ji Maharaj	Social Work	Rajasthan
104	Shri T T Jagannathan (Posthumous)	Trade and Industry	Karnataka

105	Shri Taga Ram Bheel	Art	Rajasthan
106	Shri Tarun Bhattacharya	Art	West Bengal
107	Shri Techu Gubin	Social Work	Arunachal Pradesh
108	Shri Thiruvavarur Bakthavathsalam	Art	Tamil Nadu
109	Ms. Tripti Mukherjee	Art	West Bengal
110	Shri Veezhinathan Kamakoti	Science and Engineering	Tamil Nadu
111	Shri Vempaty Kutumba Sastry	Literature and Education	Andhra Pradesh
112	Shri Vladimer Mestvirishvili (Posthumous)	Sports	Georgia
113	Shri Yumnam Jatra Singh (Posthumous)	Art	Manipur

RECALL TEST

V. S. Achuthanandhan, former Chief Minister of Kerala, was honoured posthumously with:

- A. Padma Shri
- B. Padma Bhushan
- C. Padma Vibhushan
- D. Bharat Ratna

Answer: C

N. Rajam, a Padma Vibhushan awardee, is associated with which musical instrument?

- A. Sitar
- B. Veena
- C. Sarod
- D. Violin

Answer: D

How many Padma Vibhushan awards were approved by the President of India for the year 2026?

- A) 131
- B) 113
- C) 5
- D) 13

Answer: C

The founder of Kotak Mahindra Bank was honoured with which Padma award in 2026?

- A. Padma Vibhushan
- B. Padma Bhushan
- C. Padma Shri
- D. None

Answer: B

Who is the first foreign coach to receive the Padma Shri, recognized for transforming Indian wrestling between 2003 and 2017?

- A) Shri Vladimer Mestvirishvili
- B) Ms. Liudmila Viktorovna Khokhlova
- C) Prof. Lars-Christian Koch
- D) Shri Prateek Sharma

Answer: A

QUESTION OF THE DAY

Armida Fernandez, who established Asia's first Human Milk Bank at Sion Hospital, received which Padma Award in 2026?

- A. Padma Vibhushan**
- B. Padma Bhushan**
- C. Padma Shri**
- D. None**